CANKILI II | TWO VISUAL WORLDS

Component 2 · PP1 Moodboard and Research References

CANKILI II | TWO VISUAL WORLDS

A visual direction guide for the traditional storybook and contemporary anime comic

CREATIVE CONCEPT

The Crown: one historical narrative, translated into two intentionally different illustration languages.

TRADITIONAL

Measured anatomy, earthy colours, calm staging, narration beneath the scene.

CONTEMPORARY

Bold anatomy, vivid accents, expressive faces and dialogue-led comic panels.



PROJECT DESIGN SKETCH

Supplied Cankili-inspired hero study

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Cankili II ruled Jaffna around 1617-1619. The work interprets the kingdom, contested succession and Portuguese pressure.

DESIGN RULE

An exact authenticated portrait is unavailable. Costumes and appearances are visual interpretations, not verified likenesses.

FIRST TEN STORYBOARDS

01 Jaffna / 02 Portuguese threat / 03-06 royal succession / 07 pressure / 08 trade / 09 Thanjavur route / 10 diplomatic court.

Creative concept: The Crown tells one historically inspired narrative through two distinct visual languages: a traditional illustrated storybook and a contemporary anime comic. The character sketch featured above was supplied by the project team.

MOODBOARD A | TRADITIONAL

Research-led illustration · Character and prop clarity · Simplified settings

Design choices: modest carved throne and regalia; palmyra trees, a flat coastline and simple boats; draped clothing inspired by Tamil cultural references; parchment, sand, wood, muted crimson and sea teal. Images are concept drawings rather than verified 1619 reconstructions.

MOODBOARD B | CONTEMPORARY

Anime adaptation · Strong silhouettes · Expressive comic panels

CONTEMPORARY | COMIC DIRECTION

A creative interpretation of the same story | strong silhouettes | expressive staging

01 HERO DESIGN



Existing team character reference

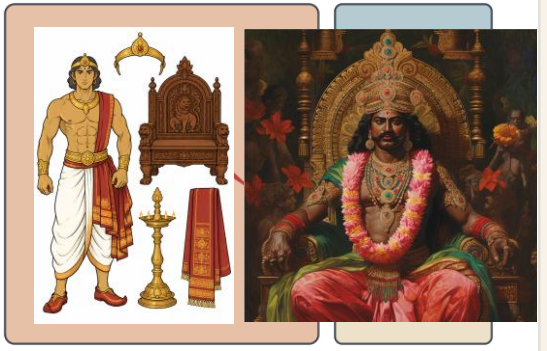
02 EXPRESSION + ACTION



FOCUS

Large face + strong gesture

03 COMIC PANELS



One large panel, two close-ups

ANIME COLOUR PALETTE

Gold + red identify the hero. White clothing and bold ink separate him from the simple background.

VISUAL STORYTELLING

Three panel layout, readable speech bubbles, dynamic but redrawable poses. Keep exact hairstyle, forehead symbol, jewellery, draped white clothing and red footwear from the approved character sketch.

Design choices: retain the approved team character’s recognisable face and hairstyle while using more dynamic anatomy, stronger colours, gold ornaments and red footwear. Use three large comic panels, simple backgrounds and dialogue balloons. Anime features are intentionally fictional.

RESEARCH AND VISUAL REFERENCES

Clickable sources accompanying the moodboard · PP1 viva evidence

History and context

Pathmanathan (1979), The Kingdom of Jaffna

De Silva, The Portuguese in Ceylon 1617–1638 (SOAS thesis)

University of Jaffna — Pathmanathan bibliography

Nallur temple official history and reconstruction timeline

Jaffna archaeological and architectural heritage report

Jaffna maritime archaeology research paper

Visual and costume references

Cankili II statue photograph — Wikimedia Commons

Cankili II statue collection — Wikimedia Commons

Nallur temple imagery — Wikimedia Commons

Nallur temple — architecture reference

Portuguese-era clothing influence — NCAS research paper

Evidence note: The original contemporary character sketch is provided by the user. The other visual panels in the moodboard are original vector concept studies. Linked monuments and modern buildings are visual references, not authenticated portraits or exact 17th-century architecture.